



Chinese Herbology Content Outline

Effective September 1, 2026

Note to Candidate: This document serves as a guide to assist in examination preparation for candidates who have met NCBAHM™ eligibility requirements. Below is the content outline for the Chinese Herbology examination.

Domain I. Chinese Herbs, Herbal Combinations and Herbal Formulas (22% of Exam)

A. Individual herbs and herbal combinations (11%)

1. Identify herbs according to their therapeutic categories.¹
2. Identify characteristics of individual herbs (e.g., tastes, temperature, directions, channels entered).
3. Identify actions and indications of individual Chinese herbs.
4. Identify treatment strategies (*Ba Fa*) of individual herbs and herbal combinations (e.g., harmonize (*He*), reduce (*Xiao*)).
5. Identify effects of processing (*Pao Zhi*) on the functions and indications of individual herbs (e.g., honey-fried (*Mi Zhi*), dry-fried (*Chao*)).
6. Identify functions and indications of common herbal pairs (*Dui Yao*).²
7. Identify mutual relationships of herbs (e.g., mutual accentuation (*Xiang Xu*), mutual antagonism (*Xiang Wu*)).
8. Identify quality and identity of raw herbs (e.g., appearance, smell, taste).

B. Chinese herbal formulas (11%)

1. Identify ingredients of herbal formulas.³
2. Identify and analyze the hierarchy within herbal formulas (e.g., chief (*Jun*), deputy (*Chen*)).
3. Identify actions and indications of herbal formulas.

¹ See Appendix A. Individual Chinese Herbs.

² See Appendix B. Chinese Herbal Pairs.

³ See Appendix C. Chinese Herbal Formulas.



4. Identify synergistic relationships of ingredients in herbal formulas.
5. Identify treatment strategies (*Ba Fa*) within herbal formulas (e.g., harmonize (*He*), sweat (*Han*)).
6. Identify potential substitutions for individual ingredients in herbal formulas.

Domain II. Safety and Quality Control (24% of Exam)

1. Identify safety and ethical issues in Chinese Herbal Medicine) that impact modern practice (e.g., red flag situations, obsolete substances, endangered species⁴).
2. Identify the regulatory framework for the practice of Chinese herbal medicine in the United States (e.g., cGMP standards, FDA oversight, Certificates of Analysis (COA), records keeping requirements, adverse events reporting).
3. Identify cautions and contraindications of herbs and herbal formulas (e.g., allergies, patient condition / life stage, pattern differentiation).
4. Identify the potential toxicity of herbs and herbal formulas (e.g., unwanted side effects, adulterant species).
5. Apply strategies to prevent the toxicity of herbs and herbal formulas (e.g., unwanted side effects).
6. Recognize potential clinically significant herb, supplement, and pharmaceutical interactions.
7. Apply strategies to avoid clinically significant herb, supplement, and pharmaceutical interactions.
8. Store, compound, dispense, and inventory herbs and formulas according to best practices and FDA requirements (e.g., temperature, moisture, expiration date).
9. Recognize signs of contamination of stored herbs and formulas.

Domain III. Treatment Planning and Administration (30% of Exam)

A. Formulation of Herbal Treatment (22%)

1. Select/Prescribe herbs and herbal combinations based on patient assessment.

⁴ See Appendix D. Obsolete Substances.

2. Select/Prescribe herbal formulas based on patient assessment.
3. Formulate an herbal treatment plan.
4. Apply substitutions for herbs and formulas (e.g., obsolete substances / endangered species, animal products, allergens).
5. Adjust the herbal treatment plan for specific patient populations (e.g., pediatrics, geriatrics, pregnancy, menstruating).
6. Determine when a patient's condition requires co-management or referral as appropriate.
7. Apply strategies for combining individual herbs to create herbal formulas.
8. Communicate the treatment plan to the patient.

B. Administration of Chinese Herbal Medicine (8%)

1. Identify common dosages of herbs, herbal combinations and formulas for various purposes (e.g., create therapeutic effectiveness, prevent toxicity).
2. Select the appropriate form of herbal administration (e.g., decoction (*tang*), pills (*wan*), medicinal wines (*jiu*), plasters (*gao*)).
3. Determine appropriate parameters for herbal medicine administration (e.g., frequency of administration, timing of doses, temperature of decoction, length of administration).
4. Apply appropriate decoction methods to prepare herbs and herbal formulas (e.g., add near the end, pre-decoct, wrap in cheesecloth).
5. Compound and dispense herbs and herbal formulas according to established best practices.
6. Administer herbal medicine and document recommendations according to best practices.
7. Advise the patient on the preparation and potential outcomes of herbal therapy (e.g., how to decoct, expected benefits, potential adverse effects).

Domain IV: Treatment Evaluation and Modification (24% of Exam)

1. Monitor patient's response to herbal therapy (e.g., beneficial effects, adverse effects).



2. Modify treatment based on patient's response to herbal therapy and clinical reassessment (e.g., Ten Questions, pulse, tongue).
3. Identify when adverse effects of herbal medicine require referral to, or co-management with biomedicine.



Appendix A. Individual Chinese Herbs

Please Note: Candidates are also responsible for being familiar with all individual herbs that are mentioned in the content outline. The exam will focus on but may not be exclusively limited to the individual herbs listed below. Individual herbs not on this list may still appear on the exam as distractors.

Herbs on this list may have potential toxicity (i.e., capable of producing unwanted side effects). Candidates should be able to apply strategies (e.g., herb selection, dosage, processing, duration of treatment) to avoid and reduce potential toxicity when practicing Chinese herbology.

- Ai Ye (*Artemisiae argyi Folium*)
- Ba Dou (*Crotonis Fructus*)
- Ba Ji Tian (*Morindae officinalis Radix*)
- Bai Bian Dou (*Lablab Semen album*)
- Bai Bu (*Stemonae Radix*)
- Bai Dou Kou (*Amomi Fructus rotundus*)
- Bai Guo (*Ginkgo Semen*)
- Bai He (*Lilii Bulbus*)
- Bai Hua She (*Agkistrodon/Bungarus*)
- Bai Hua She She Cao (*Hedyotis diffusae Herba*)
- Bai Ji (*Bletillae Rhizoma*)
- Bai Jiang Can (*Bombyx Batryticatus*)
- Bai Jiang Cao (*Patriniae Herba*)
- Bai Jie Zi (*Sinapis Semen*)
- Bai Mao Gen (*Imperatae Rhizoma*)
- Bai Qian (*Cynanchi stauntonii Rhizoma*)
- Bai Shao (*Paeoniae Radix alba*)
- Bai Tou Weng (*Pulsatillae Radix*)
- Bai Wei (*Cynanchi atrati Radix*)



- Bai Xian Pi (Dictamni Cortex)
- Bai Zhi (Angelicae dahuricae Radix)
- Bai Zhu (Atractylodis macrocephalae Rhizoma)
- Bai Zi Ren (Platycladi Semen)
- Ban Lan Gen (Isatidis/Baphicacanthis Radix)
- Ban Xia (Pinelliae Rhizoma)
- Ban Zhi Lian (Scutellariae barbatae Herba)
- Bi Ba (Piperis longi Fructus)
- Bi Xie (Dioscoreae hypoglaucae Rhizoma)
- Bian Xu (Polygoni avicularis Herba)
- Bie Jia (Trionycis Carapax)
- Bing Lang (Arecae Semen)
- Bing Pian (Borneolum)
- Bo He (Menthae haplocalycis Herba)
- Bu Gu Zhi (Psoraleae Fructus)
- Cang Er Zi (Xanthii Fructus)
- Cang Zhu (Atractylodis Rhizoma)
- Cao Dou Kou (Alpiniae katsumadai Semen)
- Cao Guo (Tsaoko Fructus)
- Cao Wu (Aconiti kusnezoffii Radix)
- Ce Bai Ye (Platycladi Cacumen)
- Chai Hu (Bupleuri Radix)
- Chan Tui (Cicadae Periostracum)
- Che Qian Zi (Plantaginis Semen)
- Chen Pi (Citri reticulatae Pericarpium)
- Chen Xiang (Aquilariae Lignum resinatum)
- Chi Shao (Paeoniae Radix rubra)
- Chi Shi Zhi (Hallsosium rubrum)
- Chi Xiao Dou (Phaseoli Semen)



- Chuan Bei Mu (*Fritillariae cirrhosae* Bulbus)
- Chuan Lian Zi (*Toosendan* Fructus)
- Chuan Mu Tong (*Clematidis armandii* Caulis)
- Chuan Niu Xi (*Cyathulae* Radix)
- Chuan Wu (*Aconiti* Radix)
- Chuan Xin Lian (*Andrographitis* Herba)
- Chuan Xiong (*Chuanxiong* Rhizoma)
- Chun Pi (*Ailanthi* Cortex)
- Ci Ji Li (*Tribuli* Fructus)
- Ci Shi (*Magnetitum*)
- Ci Wu Jia (*Acanthopanax senticosi* Radix et Caulis)
- Cong Bai (*Allii fistulosi* Bulbus)
- Da Fu Pi (*Arecae* Pericarpium)
- Da Huang (*Rhei* Radix et Rhizoma)
- Da Ji (*Cirsii japonici* Herba sive Radix)
- Da Qing Ye (*Isatidis* Folium)
- Da Zao (*Jujubae* Fructus)
- Dai Zhe Shi (*Haematitum*)
- Dan Dou Chi (*Sojae* Semen preparatum)
- Dan Shen (*Salviae miltiorrhizae* Radix)
- Dan Zhu Ye (*Lophateri* Herba)
- Dang Gui (*Angelicae sinensis* Radix)
- Dang Shen (*Codonopsis* Radix)
- Deng Xin Cao (*Junci* Medulla)
- Di Fu Zi (*Kochiae* Fructus)
- Di Gu Pi (*Lycii* Cortex)
- Di Long (*Pheretima*)
- Di Yu (*Sanguisorbae* Radix)
- Ding Xiang (*Caryophylli* Flos)



- Dong Chong Xia Cao (Cordyceps)
- Dong Gua Zi (Benincasae Semen)
- Dong Kui Zi (Malvae Fructus)
- Du Huo (Angelicae pubescentis Radix)
- Du Zhong (Eucommiae Cortex)
- E Jiao (Asini Corii Colla)
- E Zhu (Curcumae Rhizoma)
- Fan Xie Ye (Sennae Folium)
- Fang Feng (Saposhnikoviae Radix)
- Feng Mi (Mel)
- Fo Shou (Citri sarcodactylis Fructus)
- Fu Ling (Poria)
- Fu Pen Zi (Rubi Fructus)
- Fu Shen (Poriae Sclerotium paradicis)
- Fu Xiao Mai (Tritici Fructus levis)
- Fu Zi (Aconiti Radix lateralis)
- Gan Cao (Glycyrrhizae Radix)
- Gan Jiang (Zingiberis Rhizoma)
- Gan Sui (Kansui Radix)
- Gao Ben (Ligustici Rhizoma)
- Gao Liang Jiang (Alpiniae officinarum Rhizoma)
- Ge Gen (Puerariae Radix)
- Ge Jie (Gecko)
- Gou Ji (Cibotii Rhizoma)
- Gou Qi Zi (Lycii Fructus)
- Gou Teng (Uncariae Ramulus cum Uncis)
- Gu Sui Bu (Drynariae Rhizoma)
- Gu Ya (Setariae (Oryzae) Fructus germinatus)
- Gua Lou (Trichosanthis Fructus)



- Gua Lou Pi (Trichosanthis Pericarpium)
- Gua Lou Ren (Trichosanthis Semen)
- Gui Ban (Testudinis Plastrum)
- Gui Zhi (Cinnamomi Ramulus)
- Hai Jin Sha (Lygodii Spora)
- Hai Piao Xiao (Sepia Endoconcha)
- Hai Tong Pi (Erythrinae Cortex)
- Hai Zao (Sargassum)
- Han Fang Ji (Stephaniae tetrandrae Radix)
- Han Lian Cao (Ecliptae Herba)
- He Huan Pi (Albiziae Cortex)
- He Shou Wu (Polygoni multiflori Radix)
- He Tao Ren (Juglandis Semen)
- He Ye (Nelumbinis Folium)
- He Zi (Chebulae Fructus)
- Hei Zhi Ma (Sesami Semen nigrum)
- Hong Hua (Carthami Flos)
- Hou Po (Magnoliae officinalis Cortex)
- Hu Jiao (Piperis Fructus)
- Hua Jiao (Zanthoxyli Pericarpium)
- Hua Shi (Talcum)
- Huai Mi (Sophorae Flos immaturus)
- Huai Niu Xi (Achyranthis bidentatae Radix)
- Huang Bai (Phellodendri Cortex)
- Huang Jing (Polygonati Rhizoma)
- Huang Lian (Coptidis Rhizoma)
- Huang Qi (Astragali Radix)
- Huang Qin (Scutellariae Radix)
- Huo Ma Ren (Cannabis Semen)



- Huo Xiang (Pogostemonis/Agastaches Herba)
- Ji Nei Jin (Gigeria galli Endothelium corneum)
- Ji Xue Teng (Spatholobi Caulis)
- Jiang Huang (Curcumae longae Rhizoma)
- Jie Geng (Platycodi Radix)
- Jin Qian Cao (Lysimachiae Herba)
- Jin Yin Hua (Lonicerae Flos)
- Jin Ying Zi (Rosae laevigatae Fructus)
- Jing Jie (Schizonepetae Herba)
- Jing Mi (Oryzae Semen)
- Ju Hong (Citri reticulatae Exocarpium rubrum)
- Ju Hua (Chrysanthemi Flos)
- Jue Ming Zi (Cassiae Semen)
- Ku Shen (Sophorae flavescens Radix)
- Kuan Dong Hua (Farfarae Flos)
- Kun Bu (Eckloniae Thallus)
- Lai Fu Zi (Raphani Semen)
- Lian Qiao (Forsythiae Fructus)
- Lian Xu (Nelumbinis Stamen)
- Lian Zi (Nelumbinis Semen)
- Lian Zi Xin (Nelumbinis Plumula)
- Ling Yang Jiao (Saigae tataricae Cornu)
- Ling Zhi (Ganoderma)
- Liu Huang (Sulfur)
- Long Dan Cao (Gentianae Radix)
- Long Gu (Fossilia Ovis Mastodi)
- Long Yan Rou (Longan Arillus)
- Lu Dou (Phaseoli radiati Semen)
- Lu Gen (Phragmitis Rhizoma)



- Lu Hui (Aloe)
- Lu Lu Tong (Liquidambaris Fructus)
- Lu Rong (Cervi Cornu pantotrichum)
- Ma Bo (Lasiosphaera/Calvatia)
- Ma Huang (Ephedrae Herba)
- Ma Huang Gen (Ephedrae Radix)
- Mai Men Dong (Ophiopogonis Radix)
- Mai Ya (Hordei Fructus germinatus)
- Man Jing Zi (Vitis Fructus)
- Mang Xiao (Natrii Sulfas)
- Mei Gui Hua (Rosae rugosae Flos)
- Mo Yao (Myrrha)
- Mu Dan Pi (Moutan Cortex)
- Mu Gua (Chaenomeles Fructus)
- Mu Li (Ostreae Concha)
- Mu Tong (Akebiae Caulis)
- Mu Xiang (Aucklandiae Radix)
- Mu Zei (Equiseti hiemalis Herba)
- Niu Bang Zi (Arctii Fructus)
- Niu Huang (Bovis Calculus)
- Nu Zhen Zi (Ligustri lucidi Fructus)
- Ou Jie (Nelumbinis Nodus rhizomatis)
- Pang Da Hai (Sterculiae lychnophorae Semen)
- Pei Lan (Eupatorii Herba)
- Pi Pa Ye (Eriobotryae Folium)
- Pu Gong Ying (Taraxaci Herba)
- Pu Huang (Typhae Pollen)
- Qian Cao (Rubiae Radix)
- Qian Hu (Peucedani Radix)



- Qian Shi (*Euryales Semen*)
- Qiang Huo (*Notopterygii Rhizoma Seu Radix*)
- Qin Jiao (*Gentianae macrophyllae Radix*)
- Qin Pi (*Fraxini Cortex*)
- Qing Dai (*Indigo naturalis*)
- Qing Hao (*Artemisiae annuae Herba*)
- Qing Pi (*Citri reticulatae viride Pericarpium*)
- Quan Xie (*Scorpio*)
- Qu Mai (*Dianthi Herba*)
- Ren Shen (*Ginseng Radix*)
- Rou Cong Rong (*Cistanches Herba*)
- Rou Dou Kou (*Myristicae Semen*)
- Rou Gui (*Cinnamomi Cortex*)
- Ru Xiang (*Olibanum*)
- San Leng (*Sparganii Rhizoma*)
- San Qi (*Notoginseng Radix*)
- Sang Bai Pi (*Mori Cortex*)
- Sang Ji Sheng (*Taxilli Herba*)
- Sang Piao Xiao (*Mantidis Ootheca*)
- Sang Shen (*Mori Fructus*)
- Sang Ye (*Mori Folium*)
- Sang Zhi (*Mori Ramulus*)
- Sha Ren (*Amomi Fructus*)
- Sha Shen (*Glehniae/Adenophorae Radix*)
- Sha Yuan Ji Li (*Astragali complanati Semen*)
- Shan Dou Gen (*Sophorae tonkinensis Radix*)
- Shan Yao (*Dioscoreae Rhizoma*)
- Shan Zha (*Crataegi Fructus*)
- Shan Zhu Yu (*Corni Fructus*)



- She Chuang Zi (Cnidii Fructus)
- She Gan (Belamcandae Rhizoma)
- She Xiang (Moschus)
- Shen Qu (Massa medicata fermentata)
- Sheng Di Huang (Rehmanniae Radix)
- Sheng Jiang (Zingiberis Rhizoma recens)
- Sheng Ma (Cimicifugae Rhizoma)
- Shi Chang Pu (Acori tatarinowii Rhizoma)
- Shi Gao (Gypsum fibrosum)
- Shi Hu (Dendrobii Herba)
- Shi Jue Ming (Haliotidis Concha)
- Shi Wei (Pyrrosiae Folium)
- Shu Di Huang (Rehmanniae Radix preparata)
- Shui Niu Jiao (Bubali Cornu)
- Si Gua Luo (Luffae Fructus Retinervus)
- Suan Zao Ren (Ziziphi spinosae Semen)
- Suo Yang (Cynomorii Herba)
- Tai Zi Shen (Pseudostellariae Radix)
- Tan Xiang (Santali albi Lignum)
- Tao Ren (Persicae Semen)
- Tian Hua Fen (Trichosanthis Radix)
- Tian Ma (Gastrodiae Rhizoma)
- Tian Men Dong (Asparagi Radix)
- Tian Nan Xing (Arisaematis Rhizoma)
- Ting Li Zi (Lepidii/Descurainiae Semen)
- Tong Cao (Tetrapanacis Medulla)
- Tu Bie Chong (Eupolyphaga/Steleophaga)
- Tu Fu Ling (Smilacis glabrae Rhizoma)
- Tu Si Zi (Cuscutae Semen)



- Wang Bu Liu Xing (Vaccariae Semen)
- Wei Ling Xian (Clematidis Radix)
- Wu Gong (Scolopendra)
- Wu Jia Pi (Acanthopanacis Cortex)
- Wu Ling Zhi (Troglodyter Faeces)
- Wu Mei (Mume Fructus)
- Wu Wei Zi (Schisandrae Fructus)
- Wu Yao (Linderae Radix)
- Wu Zhu Yu (Evodiae Fructus)
- Xi Xian Cao (Siegesbeckiae Herba)
- Xi Xin (Asari Radix et Rhizoma)
- Xi Yang Shen (Panacis quinquefolii Radix)
- Xia Ku Cao (Prunellae Spica)
- Xian He Cao (Agrimoniae Herba)
- Xian Mao (Curculiginis Rhizoma)
- Xiang Fu (Cyperus Rhizoma)
- Xiang Ru (Moslae Herba)
- Xiao Hui Xiang (Foeniculi Fructus)
- Xiao Ji (Cirsii Herba)
- Xie Bai (Allii macrostemi Bulbus)
- Xin Yi (Magnoliae Flos)
- Xing Ren (Armeniacae Semen)
- Xu Duan (Dipsaci Radix)
- Xuan Fu Hua (Inulae Flos)
- Xuan Shen (Scrophulariae Radix)
- Yan Hu Suo (Corydalis Rhizoma)
- Ye Jiao Teng (Polygoni multiflori Caulis)
- Ye Ju Hua (Chrysanthemi indicis Flos)
- Yi Mu Cao (Leonuri Herba)

- Yi Tang (Maltosum)
- Yi Yi Ren (Coicis Semen)
- Yi Zhi Ren (Alpiniae oxyphyllae Fructus)
- Yin Chen (Artemisiae scopariae Herba)
- Yin Yang Huo (Epimedii Herba)
- Yu Jin (Curcumae Radix)
- Yu Xing Cao (Houttuyniae Herba)
- Yu Zhu (Polygonati odorati Rhizoma)
- Yuan Zhi (Polygalae Radix)
- Zao Jiao Ci (Gleditsiae Spina)
- Ze Lan (Lycopi Herba)
- Ze Xie (Alismatis Rhizoma)
- Zhe Bei Mu (Fritillariae thunbergii Bulbus)
- Zhen Zhu (Margarita)
- Zhi Ke (Aurantii Fructus)
- Zhi Mu (Anemarrhenae Radix)
- Zhi Shi (Aurantii Fructus immaturus)
- Zhi Zi (Gardeniae Fructus)
- Zhu Ling (Polyporus)
- Zhu Ru (Bambusae Caulis in taeniam)
- Zi Cao (Arnebiae/Lithospermi Radix)
- Zi Su Ye (Perillae Folium)
- Zi Su Zi (Perillae Fructus)
- Zi Wan (Asteris Radix)

Appendix B. Chinese Herbal Pairs (*Dui Yao*)

The list of Chinese herbal pairs (Dui Yao) is intended to help candidates prepare for the exam. The exam will focus on but may not be exclusively limited to the herbal pairs (Dui Yao) listed below.

- Ai Ye (*Artemisiae argyi Folium*) and E Jiao (*Asini Corii Colla*)
- Bai Shao (*Paeoniae Radix alba*) and Gan Cao (*Glycyrrhizae Radix*)
- Bai Zhu (*Atractylodis macrocephalae Rhizoma*) and Fu Ling (*Poria*)
- Ban Xia (*Pinelliae Rhizoma*) and Chen Pi (*Citri reticulatae Pericarpium*)
- Ban Xia (*Pinelliae Rhizoma*) and Sheng Jiang (*Zingiberis Rhizoma recens*)
- Cang Er Zi (*Xanthii Fructus*) and Xin Yi Hua (*Magnoliae Flos*)
- Chai Hu (*Bupleuri Radix*) and Bai Shao (*Paeoniae Radix alba*)
- Chai Hu (*Bupleuri Radix*) and Huang Qin (*Scutellariae Radix*)
- Chai Hu (*Bupleuri Radix*) and Sheng Ma (*Cimicifugae Rhizoma*)
- Da Huang (*Rhei Radix et Rhizoma*) and Mang Xiao (*Natrii Sulfas*)
- Dang Gui (*Angelicae sinensis Radix*) and Chuan Xiong (*Chuanxiong Rhizoma*)
- Dang Gui (*Angelicae sinensis Radix*) and Xiang Fu (*Cyperii Rhizoma*)
- Dang Gui (*Angelicae sinensis Radix*) and Huang Qi (*Astragali Radix*)
- Dang Gui (*Angelicae sinensis Radix*) and Rou Cong Rong (*Cistanches Herba*)
- Di Yu (*Sanguisorbae Radix*) and Huai Mi (*Sophorae Flos immaturus*)
- Du Zhong (*Eucommiae Cortex*) and Xu Duan (*Dipsaci Radix*)
- Fu Zi (*Aconiti Radix lateralis*) and Gan Jiang (*Zingiberis Rhizoma*)
- Fu Zi (*Aconiti Radix lateralis*) and Rou Gui (*Cinnamomi Cortex*)
- Ge Gen (*Puerariae Radix*) and Sheng Ma (*Cimicifugae Rhizoma*)
- Gou Qi Zi (*Lycii Fructus*) and Ju Hua (*Chrysanthemi Flos*)
- Gan Jiang (*Zingiberis Rhizoma*) and Bai Zhu (*Atractylodis macrocephalae Rhizoma*)
- Gua Lou (*Trichosanthis Fructus*) and Xie Bai (*Allii macrostemi Bulbus*)
- Gui Ban (*Testudinis Plastrum*) and Bie Jia (*Trionycis Carapax*)
- Gui Zhi (*Cinnamomi Ramulus*) and Bai Shao (*Paeoniae Radix alba*)
- Han Lian Cao (*Ecliptae Herba*) and Nu Zhen Zi (*Ligustri lucidi Fructus*)

- Huang Lian (Coptidis Rhizoma) and Rou Gui (Cinnamomi Cortex)
- Huo Xiang (Pogostemonis/Agastaches Herba) and Pei Lan (Eupatorii Herba)
- Jie Geng (Platycodi Radix) and Gan Cao (Glycyrrhizae Radix)
- Jin Qian Cao (Lysimachiae Herba) and Hai Jin Sha (Lygodii Spora)
- Jin Yin Hua (Lonicerae Flos) and Lian Qiao (Forsythia Fructus)
- Jing Jie (Schizonepetae Herba) and Fang Feng (Saposhnikoviae Radix)
- Long Gu (Fossilia Osis Mastodi) and Mu Li (Ostreae Concha)
- Ma Huang (Ephedrae Herba) and Gui Zhi (Cinnamomi Ramulus)
- Ma Huang (Ephedrae Herba) and Shi Gao (Gypsum fibrosum)
- Ma Huang (Ephedrae Herba) and Xing Ren (Armeniacae Semen)
- Mai Men Dong (Ophiopogonis Radix) and Sha Shen (Glehniae/Adenophorae Radix)
- Niu Bang Zi (Arctii Fructus) and Lian Qiao (Forsythiae Fructus)
- Ren Shen (Ginseng Radix) and Huang Qi (Astragali Radix)
- Qing Hao (Artemisiae annuae Herba) and Bie Jia (Trionycis Carapax)
- Ru Xiang (Olibanum) and Mo Yao (Myrrha)
- San Leng (Sparganii Rhizoma) and E Zhu (Curcumae Rhizoma)
- Sang Bai Pi (Mori Cortex) and Di Gu Pi (Lycii Cortex)
- Sang Ye (Mori Folium) and Ju Hua (Chrysanthemi Flos)
- Sheng Jiang (Zingiberis Rhizoma recens) and Da Zao (Jujubae Fructus)
- Shi Gao (Gypsum fibrosum) and Zhi Mu (Anemarrhenae Radix)
- Tao Ren (Persicae Semen) and Hong Hua (Carthami Flos)
- Tian Ma (Gastrodiae Rhizoma) and Gou Teng (Uncariae Ramulus cum Uncus)
- Ting Li Zi (Lepidii/Descurainiae Semen) and Da Zao (Jujubae Fructus)
- Zhi Mu (Anemarrhenae Radix) and Huang Bai (Phellodendri Cortex)
- Zhi Zi (Gardeniae Fructus) and Dan Dou Chi (Sojae Semen preparatum)
- Zi Wan (Asteris Radix) and Kuan Dong Hua (Farfarae Flos)



Appendix C. Chinese Herbal Formulas

Please Note: Candidates are also responsible for being familiar with all formulas that are mentioned in the content outline. The exam will focus on but may not be exclusively limited to the herbal formulas listed below. Formulas not on this list may still appear on the exam as distractors.

Formulas on this list may contain potentially toxic (i.e., capable of producing unwanted side effects) ingredients or obsolete substances. Candidates should be able to apply strategies (e.g., dosage, substitution, duration of treatment) to avoid obsolete substances and reduce potential toxicity when practicing Chinese herbology.

- Ba Zhen Tang (Eight-Treasure Decoction)
- Ba Zheng San (Eight-Herb Powder for Rectification)
- Bai He Gu Jin Tang (Lily Bulb Decoction to Preserve the Metal)
- Bai Hu Tang (White Tiger Decoction)
- Bai Tou Weng Tang (Pulsatilla Decoction)
- Ban Xia Bai Zhu Tian Ma Tang (Pinellia, White Atractylodes, and Gastrodia Decoction)
- Ban Xia Hou Po Tang (Pinellia and Magnolia Bark Decoction)
- Ban Xia Xie Xin Tang (Pinellia Decoction to Drain the Epigastrium)
- Bao He Wan (Preserve Harmony Pill)
- Bei Mu Gua Lou San (Fritillaria and Trichosanthes Fruit Powder)
- Bu Fei Tang (Tonify the Lungs Decoction)
- Bu Yang Huan Wu Tang (Tonify the Yang to Restore Five (-Tenths) Decoction)
- Bu Zhong Yi Qi Tang (Tonify the Middle to Augment the Qi Decoction)
- Cang Er Zi San (Xanthium Powder)
- Chai Ge Jie Ji Tang (Bupleurum and Kudzu Decoction to Release the Muscle Layer)
- Chai Hu Gui Zhi Tang (Bupleurum and Cinnamon Twig Decoction)
- Chai Hu Jia Long Gu Mu Li Tang (Bupleurum plus Dragon Bone and Oyster Shell Decoction)
- Chai Hu Shu Gan San (Bupleurum Powder to Dredge the Liver)



- Chuan Xiong Cha Tiao San (Chuanxiong Powder to be Taken with Green Tea)
- Da Bu Yin Wan (Great Tonify the Yin Pill)
- Da Chai Hu Tang (Major Bupleurum Decoction)
- Da Cheng Qi Tang (Major Order the Qi Decoction)
- Da Jian Zhong Tang (Major Construct the Middle Decoction)
- Da Huang Mu Dan Tang (Rhubarb and Moutan Decoction)
- Da Qing Long Tang (Major Bluegreen Dragon Decoction)
- Dan Shen Yin (Salvia Drink)
- Dang Gui Bu Xue Tang (Tangkuei Decoction to Tonify the Blood)
- Dang Gui Liu Huang Tang (Tangkuei and Six-Yellow Decoction)
- Dang Gui Shao Yao San (Tangkuei and Peony Powder)
- Dang Gui Si Ni Tang (Tangkuei Decoction for Frigid Extremities)
- Dang Gui Yin Zi (Tangkuei Drink)
- Dao Chi San (Guide Out the Red Powder)
- Ding Chuan Tang (Arrest Wheezing Decoction)
- Ding Zhi Wan (Settle the Emotions Pill)
- Du Huo Ji Sheng Tang (Pubescent Angelica and Taxillus Decoction)
- Du Qi Wan (Capital Qi Pill)
- Er Chen Tang (Two-Aged (Herb) Decoction)
- Er Miao San (Two-Marvel Powder)
- Er Xian Tang (Two-Immortal Decoction)
- Er Zhi Wan (Two-Solstice Pill)
- Fang Feng Tong Sheng San (Saposhnikovia Powder That Sagely Unblocks)
- Fang Ji Huang Qi Tang (Stephania and Astragalus Decoction)
- Fu Yuan Huo Xue Tang (Revive Health by Invigorating the Blood Decoction)
- Fu Zi Li Zhong Wan (Aconite Accessory Root Pill to Regulate the Middle)
- Gan Mai Da Zao Tang (Licorice, Wheat, and Jujube Decoction)
- Ge Gen Huang Qin Huang Lian Tang (Kudzu, Scutellaria, and Coptis Decoction)
- Ge Gen Tang (Kudzu Decoction)



- Ge Xia Zhu Yu Tang (Drive Out Stasis Below the Diaphragm Decoction)
- Gu Jing Wan (Stabilize the Menses Pill)
- Gua Lou Xie Bai Ban Xia Tang (Trichosanthes Fruit, Chinese Garlic, and Pinellia Decoction)
- Gui Pi Tang (Restore the Spleen Decoction)
- Gui Zhi Fu Ling Wan (Cinnamon Twig and Poria Pill)
- Gui Zhi Jia Long Gu Mu Li Tang (Cinnamon Twig Decoction plus Dragon Bone and Oyster Shell)
- Gui Zhi Shao Yao Zhi Mu Tang (Cinnamon Twig, Peony, and Anemarrhena Decoction)
- Gui Zhi Tang (Cinnamon Twig Decoction)
- Huai Hua San (Sophora Japonica Flower Powder)
- Huang Lian E Jiao Tang (Coptis and Ass-Hide Gelatin Decoction)
- Huang Lian Jie Du Tang (Coptis Decoction to Resolve Toxicity)
- Huang Qi Jian Zhong Tang (Astragalus Decoction to Construct the Middle)
- Huo Xiang Zheng Qi San (Patchouli/Agastache Powder to Rectify the Qi)
- Ji Chuan Jian (Benefit the River (Flow) Decoction)
- Jia Jian Wei Rui Tang (Modified Solomon's Seal Decoction)
- Jia Wei Xiao Yao San (Augmented Rambling Powder)
- Jiao Ai Tang (Ass-Hide Gelatin and Mugwort Decoction)
- Jin Ling Zi San (Melia Toosendan Powder)
- Jin Suo Gu Jing Wan (Metal Lock Pill to Stabilize the Essence)
- Jing Fang Bai Du San (Schizonepeta and Saposhnikovia Powder to Overcome Pathogenic Influences)
- Ju Pi Zhu Ru Tang (Tangerine Peel and Bamboo Shavings Decoction)
- Juan Bi Tang (Remove Painful Obstructions from *Awakening of the Mind in Medical Studies*)
- Li Zhong Wan (Regulate the Middle Pill)
- Liang Fu Wan (Galangal and Cyperus Pill)
- Liang Ge San (Cool the Diaphragm Powder)



- Ling Gui Zhu Gan Tang (Poria, Cinnamon Twig, Atractylodes, and Licorice Decoction)
- Ling Jiao Gou Teng Yin (Antelope Horn and Uncaria Decoction)
- Liu Jun Zi Tang (Six-Gentlemen Decoction)
- Liu Wei Di Huang Wan (Six-Ingredient Pill with Rehmannia)
- Liu Yi San (Six-to-One Powder)
- Long Dan Xie Gan Tang (Gentian Decoction to Drain the Liver)
- Ma Huang Tang (Ephedra Decoction)
- Ma Xing Shi Gan Tang (Ephedra, Apricot Kernel, Gypsum and Licorice Decoction)
- Ma Zi Ren Wan (Hemp Seed Pill)
- Mai Men Dong Tang (Ophiopogonis Decoction)
- Mu Li San (Oyster Shell Powder)
- Nuan Gan Jian (Warm the Liver Decoction)
- Ping Wei San (Calm the Stomach Powder)
- Pu Ji Xiao Du Yin (Universal Benefit Drink to Eliminate Toxin)
- Qi Ju Di Huang Wan (Lycium Fruit, Chrysanthemum, and Rehmannia Pill)
- Qian Zheng San (Lead to Symmetry Powder)
- Qiang Huo Sheng Shi Tang (Notopterygium Decoction to Overcome Dampness)
- Qing Gu San (Cool the Bones Powder)
- Qing Hao Bie Jia Tang (Sweet Wormwood and Soft-shelled Turtle Shell Decoction)
- Qing Qi Hua Tan Wan (Clear the Qi and Transform Phlegm Pill)
- Qing Wei San (Clear the Stomach Powder)
- Qing Wen Bai Du Yin (Clear Epidemics and Overcome Toxicity Drink)
- Qing Ying Tang (Clear the Nutritive Level Decoction)
- Qing Zao Jiu Fei Tang (Clear Dryness and Rescue the Lungs Decoction)
- Ren Shen Bai Du San (Ginseng Powder to Overcome Pathogenic Influences)
- Run Chang Wan (Moisten the Intestines Pill from Master Shen's Book)
- San Ren Tang (Three-Seed Decoction)
- San Zi Yang Qin Tang (Three-Seed Decoction to Nourish One's Parents)
- Sang Ju Yin (Mulberry Leaf and Chrysanthemum Drink)

- Sang Piao Xiao San (Mantis Egg-Case Powder)
- Sang Xing Tang (Mulberry Leaf and Apricot Kernel Decoction)
- Sha Shen Mai Men Dong Tang (Glehnia and Ophiopogonis Decoction)
- Shao Fu Zhu Yu Tang (Drive Out Stasis from the Lower Abdomen Decoction)
- Shao Yao Gan Cao Tang (Peony and Licorice Decoction)
- Shao Yao Tang (Peony Decoction)
- Shen Fu Tang (Ginseng and Aconite Accessory Root Decoction)
- Shen Ling Bai Zhu San (Ginseng, Poria, and White Atractylodes Powder)
- Shen Qi Wan (Kidney Qi Pill)
- Shen Tong Zhu Yu Tang (Drive Out Stasis from a Painful Body Decoction)
- Sheng Hua Tang (Generating and Transforming Decoction)
- Sheng Mai San (Generate the Pulse Powder)
- Sheng Ma Ge Gen Tang (Cimicifuga and Kudzu Decoction)
- Shi Hui San (Ten Partially-charred Substances Powder)
- Shi Pi Yin (Bolster the Spleen Drink)
- Shi Quan Da Bu Tang (All-Inclusive Great Tonifying Decoction)
- Shi Xiao San (Sudden Smile Powder)
- Shou Tai Wan (Fetus Longevity Pill)
- Si Jun Zi Tang (Four-Gentlemen Decoction)
- Si Miao Wan (Four-Marvel Pill)
- Si Ni San (Frigid Extremities Powder)
- Si Ni Tang (Frigid Extremities Decoction)
- Si Shen Wan (Four-Miracle Pill)
- Si Wu Tang (Four-Substance Decoction)
- Su Zi Jiang Qi Tang (Perilla Fruit Decoction for Directing Qi Downward)
- Suan Zao Ren Tang (Sour Jujube Decoction)
- Taishan Pan Shi San (Taishan Bedrock Powder)
- Tao He Cheng Qi Tang (Peach Pit Decoction to Order the Qi)
- Tao Hong Si Wu Tang (Four-Substance Decoction with Safflower and Peach Pit)



- Tian Ma Gou Teng Yin (Gastrodia and Uncaria Drink)
- Tian Tai Wu Yao San (Top-Quality Lindera Powder)
- Tian Wang Bu Xin Dan (Emperor of Heaven's Special Pill to Tonify the Heart)
- Tiao Wei Cheng Qi Tang (Regulate the Stomach and Order the Qi Decoction)
- Tong Xie Yao Fang (Important Formula for Painful Diarrhea)
- Wan Dai Tang (End Discharge Decoction)
- Wen Dan Tang (Warm Gallbladder Decoction)
- Wen Jing Tang (Flow-Warming Decoction)
- Wu Ling San (Five-Ingredient Powder with Poria)
- Wu Pi San (Five-Peel Powder)
- Wu Wei Xiao Du Yin (Five-Ingredient Drink to Eliminate Toxin)
- Wu Zhu Yu Tang (Evodia Decoction)
- Xi Jiao Di Huang Wan (Rhinoceros Horn and Rehmannia Decoction)
- Xiang Sha Liu Jun Zi Tang (Six-Gentlemen Decoction with Aucklandia and Amomum)
- Xiang Su San (Cyperus and Perilla Leaf Powder)
- Xiao Chai Hu Tang (Minor Bupleurum Decoction)
- Xiao Cheng Qi Tang (Minor Order the Qi Decoction)
- Xiao Feng San (Eliminate Wind Powder from *Orthodox Lineage*)
- Xiao Huo Luo Dan (Minor Invigorate the Collaterals Special Pill)
- Xiao Ji Yin Zi (Small Thistle Drink)
- Xiao Jian Zhong Tang (Minor Construct the Middle Decoction)
- Xiao Qing Long Tang (Minor Bluegreen Dragon Decoction)
- Xiao Yao San (Rambling Powder)
- Xie Bai San (Drain the White Powder)
- Xie Huang San (Drain the Yellow Powder)
- Xie Xin Tang (Drain the Epigastrium Decoction)
- Xing Su San (Apricot Kernel and Perilla Leaf Powder)
- Xuan Fu Dai Zhe Tang (Inula and Hematite Decoction)
- Xue Fu Zhu Yu Tang (Drive Out Stasis from the Mansion of Blood Decoction)



- Yang He Tang (Balmy Yang Decoction)
- Yi Guan Jian (Linking Decoction)
- Yin Chen Hao Tang (Virgate Wormwood Decoction)
- Yin Qiao San (Honeysuckle and Forsythia Powder)
- You Gui Wan (Restore the Right (Kidney) Pill)
- You Gui Yin (Restore the Right (Kidney) Drink)
- Yu Nu Jian (Jade Woman Decoction)
- Yu Ping Feng San (Jade Windscreen Powder)
- Yue Ju Wan (Escape Restraint Pill)
- Zeng Ye Cheng Qi Tang (Increase the Fluids and Order the Qi Decoction)
- Zeng Ye Tang (Increase the Fluids Decoction)
- Zhen Gan Xi Feng Tang (Sedate the Liver and Extinguish Wind Decoction)
- Zhen Ren Yang Zang Tang (True Man's Decoction to Nourish the Organs)
- Zhen Wu Tang (True Warrior Decoction)
- Zhi Bai Di Huang Wan (Anemarrhena, Phellodendron, and Rehmannia Pill)
- Zhi Gan Cao Tang (Prepared Licorice Decoction)
- Zhi Sou San (Stop Coughing Powder)
- Zhu Ling Tang (Polyporus Decoction)
- Zhu Ye Shi Gao Tang (Lophatherum and Gypsum Decoction)
- Zuo Gui Wan (Restore the Left (Kidney) Pill)
- Zuo Gui Yin (Restore the Left (Kidney) Drink)
- Zuo Jin Wan (Left Metal Pill)

Appendix D. Obsolete Substances

Herbs on the Obsolete Substances list have been used in formulas and in clinical practice historically, but due to issues of toxicity or endangered status, are considered obsolete. Candidates should be able 1.) to identify actions and indications, 2.) to identify issues around toxicity and/or endangered status of the following herbs and 3.) to apply substitutions.

- Chuan Shan Jia (Manitis Squama)
- Guan Mu Tong (Aristolochiae manshuriensis Caulis)
- Guang Fang Ji (Aristolochiae Fangchi Radix)
- Hu Gu (Tigris Os)
- Ma Dou Ling (Aristolochiae Fructus)
- Xi Jiao (Rhinocerotis Cornu)
- Xiong Dan (Vesica Fellea Ursi)
- Ying Su Ke (Papaveris Pericarpium)
- Zhu Sha (Cinnabaris)



Chinese Herbology Examination Suggested Bibliography

The Content Outline is the primary resource for studying for this examination. The purpose of this Bibliography is only to provide the candidate with suggested resources to utilize in preparation for the examination. Candidates should feel free to consider other resources that cover the material in the Content Outline.

There is no single text recommended by NCBAHM™. All NCBAHM™ examination modules reflect practice in the United States as determined by the most recent job analysis.

NCBAHM™'s item writers and examination development committee members frequently use the following texts as resources; however, the sources used are not limited to the books listed here. The NCBAHM™ does not endorse any third-party study/preparation guide.

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<http://www.fda.gov/Drugs/DevelopmentApprovalProcess/Manufacturing/ucm169105.htm>